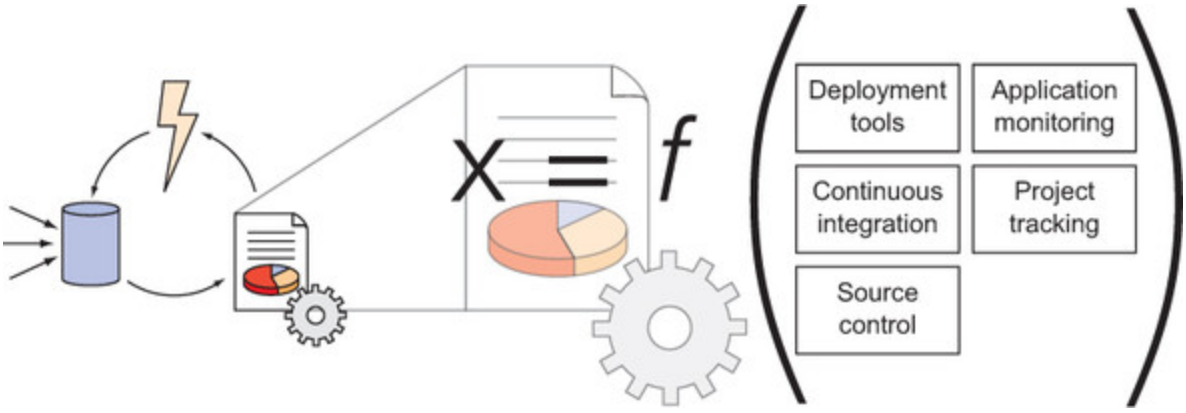
1.4. Analyzing what you have and what to do with the data

The second step in the feedback loop is analysis, or figuring out what to do with all the data you've collected. This is where you ask questions, look for trends, and associate data points with behaviors in order to understand what is behind your team's performance trends.

Essentially what you need to do is get all the data you've collected and run some kind of computation on it, as shown in figure 1.10, to determine what the combined data points can tell you. The best place to start is with the question you're trying to answer. When you're doing this, be careful and ask yourself *why* you want to know what you're asking. Does it really help you answer your question, solve a problem, or track something that you want to ensure you're improving? When you're trying to figure out what metrics to track, it's easy to fall into a rabbit hole of "it would be great to have." Be wary of that. Stick with "just in time" instead of "just in case" when it comes to thinking about metrics. Then plug X into figure 1.10, where X is the question you want to answer.

Figure 1.10. X is what you want to answer; some combination of your data can get you there.



1.4.1. Figuring out what matters

If you're swimming in a sea of data, it's hard to figure out what data answers what question and which metrics you should track. One strategy I find useful when I'm trying to figure out which metrics matter is mind mapping.